



Component Guide

Use this guide to identify your components when setting up. Components are grouped by which game mode uses them.

This game is still in development.

This rulebook (and all images shown) are a work in progress.



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War of the Dragon: The Wheel of Time® Draft Rulebook — Work in Progress — May 28, 2026

Your Characters

Your copy of the game includes either plastic miniatures or cardboard standees — one for each character. Both represent the same pieces and work the same way.

Whether you have miniatures or standees, they are referred to in the rest of the game as “figures.”



Rand al'Thor



Perrin Aybara



Mat Cauthon



Egwene al'Vere



Nynaeve al'Meara



Rahvin



Sammael



Padan Fain



Lan Mandragoran



Mazrim Taim



Be'lal



Graendal



Lanfear



Mesaana



Semirhage



Aviendha



Cadsuane
Melaidhrin



Elaida do
Avriny a'Roihan



Elayne Trakand



Faile Bashere



Galad Damodred



Gareth Bryne



Gawyn Trakand



Jahar Narishma



Liandrin Guirale



Logain Ablar



Loial, Son of
Arent



Min Farshaw



Thom Merrilin



Verin Mathwin

Shared Components

These components are used in both Hero Mode and Epic Mode:



Main board



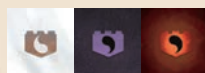
2 player boards
(1 Light, 1 Shadow)



2 Wheel trackers
(1 Light, 1 Shadow)



Chapter board (double-sided)



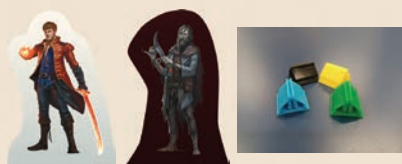
Light Banner tracker,
Shadow Banner tracker,
and Shadow Corruption tracker



12 corruption markers



30 control markers
(Light and Shadow sides)



30 character figures with bases



Chapter tracker



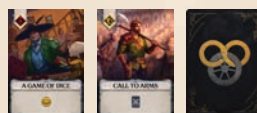
2 player pawns
(1 Light, 1 Shadow)



7 region control badges
(Light and Shadow sides)



25 crowns



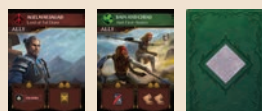
10 Light player cards



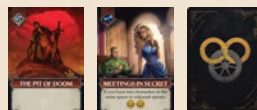
4 mission markers



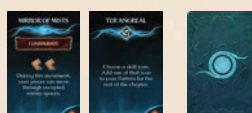
5 "1-pip" mission cards
30 "2-pip" mission cards
10 "3-pip" mission cards



70 ally cards
+ 5 Starter Ally cards



13 Shadow player cards



40 Power cards



4 mission bonus tokens
(Light and Shadow sides)



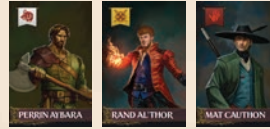
2 ally reward tokens

Hero Mode Only

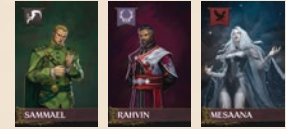
Set these aside if you're playing Epic Mode.



Hero Mode action board



*3 Light leader cards
(Perrin Aybara, Rand al'Thor, Mat Cauthon)*



*3 Shadow leader cards
(Sammael, Rahvin, Mesaana)*

Epic Mode Only



Set these aside if you're playing Hero Mode.

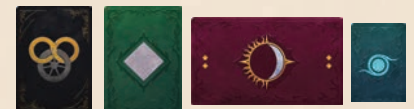
Cards marked with the heron-mark symbol (shown at right) belong to this group.



Epic Mode action board



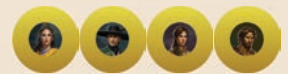
1 secrecy screen



*Heron-marked player cards, ally cards,
mission cards, and Power cards*



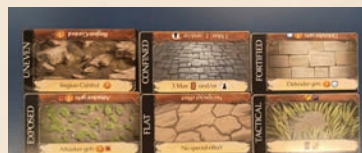
*2 Inner Wheel discs
(1 Light, 1 Shadow)*



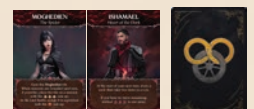
4 leader tokens



*2 battle boards
(1 Light, 1 Shadow)*



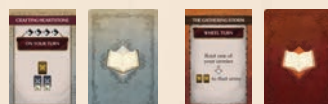
*6 standard terrain tiles
+ 3 Last Battle terrain tiles*



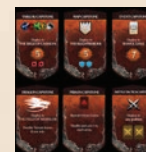
11 Prison cards



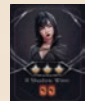
8 army figures



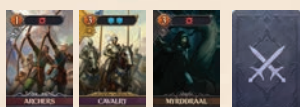
*38 Light event cards
+ 38 Shadow event cards*



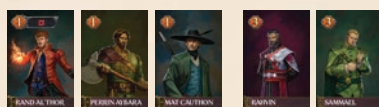
6 endgame capstone tiles



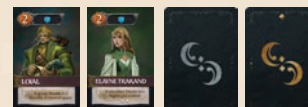
1 Moghedien tile



112 troop cards



*16 Light character cards
+ 3 Shadow character cards*



*16 neutral character cards (silver icon)
+ 7 special character cards (gold icon)*



HERO MODE

This game is still in development.

This rulebook (and all images shown) are a work in progress.

The Wheel of Time turns, and Ages come and pass, leaving memories that become legend.

Hero Mode is a complete War of the Dragon experience — approachable enough to learn in an evening, rich enough to reward every decision you make. If this is your first game, start here.

Rand al'Thor and his allies race to unite the fractured nations of the Westlands, while the Forsaken work to tear them apart. The side that better prepares for Tarmon Gai'don will determine the fate of the world.

THE SHAPE OF THE GAME

War of the Dragon is a two-player game. One player commands the Light; the other commands the Shadow. Both sides share the same five actions but pursue different goals and use different tools to pursue them.

The game takes place over three Chapters. Each Chapter, you play a hand of cards — one per turn. Every card you play powers up one action. After three Chapters, both sides score victory points across several categories, and the higher total wins.

The map, your Pattern, your leaders, and your tracks are where the game is won and lost. The rest of this rulebook explains how.

Setup

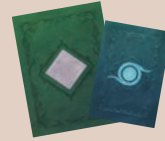
In our examples throughout this rulebook, Roland plays the Light and Isabel plays the Shadow.

1. SET OUT THE SHARED BOARDS

Place the main board, the Hero Mode action board, and the Chapter board (heron-mark side face-down) in the play area. The Light sits on the left (western) side of the map; the Shadow on the right (eastern) side.

2. PREPARE THE DECKS

Remove all cards bearing the heron-mark symbol from the Power, ally, mission, and player decks. The heron-mark represents cards used in Epic Mode — set them aside.



Shuffle the ally and Power decks and place them near the action board.

3. EACH PLAYER PREPARES THEIR AREA

Both players do the following.

STARTING DECK (shuffle and place face-down beside your player board):

Set aside Ta'veren (Light) and The Taint on Saidin (Shadow) — they are used only in Epic Mode.

Light (9 cards):

- A Game of Dice
- Call to Arms
- Lan Mandragoran
- Leavetaking
- Moiraine Damodred
- Preparations
- The Flame and the Void
- The One Power
- The World of Dreams

Shadow starting deck (12 cards):

- Meetings in Secret
- Rats and Ravens
- Shadowsworn Oaths
- The Black Ajah
- The Pit of Doom
- The Shadow's Touch
- The Ways
- The Weakening Seals (5 cards)



Place your player board. Take your action pawn.

Place your three leader cards in their matching slots on your player board. Use the dials to set each leader's strength to 2 (Light) or 3 (Shadow).



Place your Wheel tracker emblem-side up on the starting space of your Wheel Track.



Light: your fourth leader slot is unused in Hero Mode.

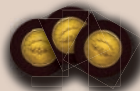
4. STARTING ALLIES

Shuffle the five Starter Ally cards and deal two to each player. Return the fifth to the box. Each player tucks their two allies under their player board in the slot matching the icon in the top left of each card — these are the start of your Patterns.



5. CROWNS

Both players take 3 crowns.



6. PLACE SET TRACKERS



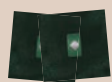
Light's Banner tracker — starting space, left edge of the board



Shadow's Banner tracker — starting space, right edge of the board



Shadow's Corruption tracker — starting space, right edge of the board



Two ally reward tokens — marked spaces on Light's Banner Track

7. PLACE CHARACTERS ON TRACKS

Choose two neutral character figures, attach white bases, and place one on each character icon (👤) on Light's Banner Track. *(We recommend Elayne Trakand and Thom Merrilin — the choice doesn't affect gameplay.)*

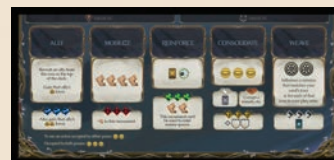
Choose two unused Forsaken figures, attach black bases, and place one on each character icon on Shadow's Corruption Track. *(We recommend Lanfear and Semirhage.)*



Main board



Chapter board



Action board



8. BUILD THE MISSION DECK

Sort missions by their card backs, then assemble the deck:

- Shuffle the nine 2-pip missions and deal four face-down.
- Shuffle the five 1-pip missions and deal two face-down on top.
- You now have a 6-card Mission Deck. Return all remaining missions to the box.



9. SET UP THE MAP

Place characters in their starting positions:

Shadow:

- Sammael (blue leader base) in Illian, with a corruption marker
- Rahvin (blue leader base) in Caemlyn, with a corruption marker
- Mesaana (blue leader base) in Unclaimed Lands
- Padan Fain (black base) in Amadicia
- Graendal (black base) in Arad Doman

Light:

- Rand (yellow leader base) in Rhuidean
- Perrin (yellow leader base) in The Two Rivers
- Mat (yellow leader base), Egwene (white base), and Lan (white base) in Tear
- Nynaeve (white base) in Tanchico

10. PLACE CHAPTER TRACKER

Place the Chapter tracker on the first space of the Chapter track.

Playing the Game

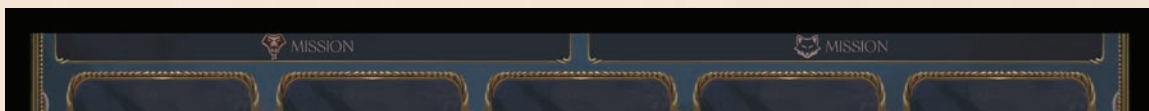
The game unfolds over three Chapters. In each one, you'll expand your hold on the map, build your Pattern, and compete over the missions that define the story.

CHAPTER SETUP

At the start of each Chapter, do three things in order:

REVEAL TWO MISSIONS.

Reveal the top two cards of the Mission Deck and place them in the two mission slots above the action board — one in the Snake slot, one in the Fox slot. Each slot is labeled with its icon, which matches the mission marker you'll place on the map.



Place the appropriate mission marker on each board space shown in the top right of that mission's card. If you already control one of those spaces, place an appropriate mission bonus token on the mission with your side face-up. (Each of these spaces is referred to throughout the rules as a “mission space.”)



The mission in the Fox slot, Trolloc Raids, has a mission marker in Braem Wood.

Since Rahvin is already in that space, Isabel puts a Fox mission bonus token on Trolloc Raids with the Shadow side up.



REFRESH THE ALLY ROW.

Deal three ally cards face-up near the action board. In Chapter 2 and beyond, discard the previous row first.

DRAW HANDS.

Each player draws from their deck: 4 cards in Chapter 1, 5 in Chapter 2, 6 in Chapter 3. If your deck runs out, shuffle your discard pile and keep drawing.



YOUR TURN

The Shadow goes first in Chapters 1 and 3; the Light goes first in Chapter 2. A circle on the Chapter track marks the starting player. Players alternate turns until both hands are empty.

On each of your turns, play a card face-up in front of you and move your action pawn to one of the five actions on the board. Resolve the card and the action in whichever order you prefer. Discard your card. Then your opponent takes their turn.

ALLY

MOBILIZE

REINFORCE

CONSOLIDATE

WEAVE

CARDS AND ICONS

Each card has a skill icon in its upper left corner. Your actions may have a bonus effect depending on how many icons of a particular skill you have during your turn — counting both your Pattern (the ally cards tucked under your board) and the card you just played.

If you play a card with a wild icon, choose one skill for it to count as this turn.



A wild icon

OCCUPIED ACTIONS

Both players use the same action board, and your opponent's pawn doesn't block you — it just costs you. If one pawn already occupies your chosen action, pay 2 crowns to take it. If both pawns are there when you start your turn, pay 3 crowns.



The Ally and Reinforce actions are occupied. Taking either action at this time would cost 2 crowns.

Watch your opponent's crown supply. If they can't afford 2 crowns, they can't follow you onto your action or repeat one they just took — a real constraint in a tight game.



This card from the Light's deck can enable some surprising plays!

THE FIVE ACTIONS

Ally



Recruit an ally and add them to your Pattern.

Pick one of the three face-up allies near the action board, or take the top card of the ally deck. You gain the favor of the ally you selected or drew — the immediate reward shown on the left side of their card, if they have one.

If you have 3 or more icons, also gain the bonus favor shown on the right side of their card, if they have one.

Then tuck the card under your player board (according to its skill icon) and refill the row.

Build your Pattern. At the end of the game, you'll score 2 VP for each of the five skills where you have more icons than your opponent.

STRATEGY

A strong Pattern compounds over time — each ally you add makes your actions more powerful and brings you closer to the 3-icon threshold that unlocks bonus favors.

Example Turn

It is Roland's turn. He plays a card from his hand and moves his pawn to the Ally action. Since Isabel's pawn is already there, Roland pays 2 crowns to the supply.

The card Roland plays is *Moiraine Damodred*. This card has no effect to resolve, but it does have a wild icon. Roland chooses for that wild to count as a icon this turn. Combined with the two icons in Roland's Pattern, that will let him gain the bonus effect from his Ally action.

Roland now resolves his Ally action. He chooses an available ally from the face-up row, Juilin Sandar.



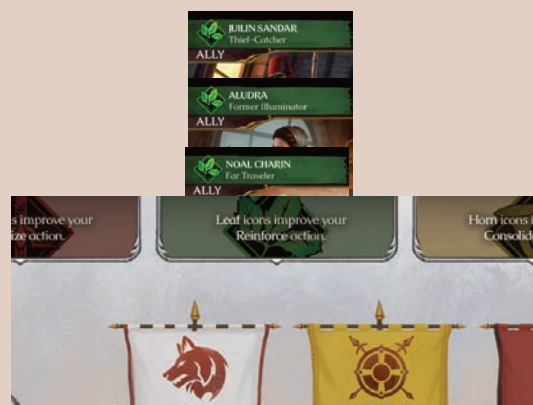
As part of the Ally action, Roland gains the 🐉 favor from his chosen card: he gains one crown.



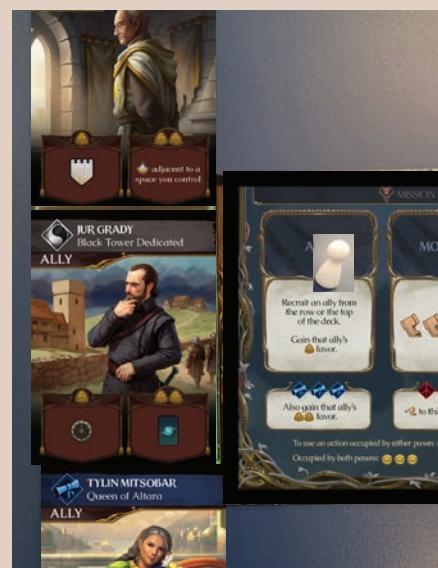
Because Roland has three 🗡️ icons in his play area, the Ally action also grants him Juilin's 🐉 favor: he chooses to add three of his control markers to the *Trolloc Raids* mission, giving him the lead on the mission (over Isabel's bonus token from controlling Braem Wood, which is a mission space).



Roland adds Juilin to his Pattern. This gives him three permanent 🌿 icons in his Pattern, so he can gain the bonus effect from the Reinforce action on a future turn, whether the card played from his hand has that icon or not.



Finally, Roland refills the ally row and ends his turn.



Mobilize



Move your characters on the map — claim territory, contest mission spaces, or pressure your opponent.

You get **four moves**. If you have 3 or more  icons, you get **five**. Each move lets you take any group of your characters in the same space and move them one space together. You can split groups, use moves in any order, and move the same characters more than once.

Claiming Territory

You control every space where you have a character or a control marker — or, if you're the Shadow, a corruption marker.

The map is divided into seven colored regions. When you control more than half the spaces in a region, you claim it: slide your region control badge into the slot in that region with your side face-up (flipping it if your opponent already has one there), and advance your Banner one space.

You keep a region until your opponent reclaims a majority there, or you hold no spaces in it. Losing a region costs you no Banner progress — but your opponent gains a Banner when they take it.

Each region requires a different number of spaces to claim. The threshold for each region is shown on the map.



Shadow controls 2 of the 3 spaces in this region, so they gain control of it.



STRATEGY

Mobilize is your main engine for Banner progress. Each region you claim and each conflict you win advances your Banner — and controlling mission spaces lets you start a turn already ahead on those missions.

CONTROL MARKERS



When one of your characters moves out of a space, you may pay 1 crown to place a control marker there, holding the space without keeping a character in it. You may only do this in a space where that character began their move — not in spaces they passed through.

Some effects place control markers for free. These cannot go into spaces containing enemy characters, but can replace lone enemy control markers.

MISSION SPACES



When you take control of a mission space, place a mission bonus token with your side face-up on the corresponding mission card. If you took the space from your opponent, instead flip their bonus token on that mission over to your side. If you lose control of a mission space, remove the token from the mission.

MOVING INTO ENEMY TERRITORY

Moving into a space your opponent controls requires strength. Your total strength in the moving group must **exceed** theirs in that space.

- Leader characters have strength equal to their current value — you may ask your opponent their leader's current strength at any time.
- Other characters have 1 strength.
- A corruption marker adds 1 to the Shadow's strength in that space. Corruption markers are stationary, so they only count when the Light is moving into a space.

If the strength of your moving characters falls short, you may spend crowns or discard Power cards to cover the difference — 1 crown or card per +1 strength.



A space containing at least one character is occupied. Control and corruption markers do not make a space occupied. Once you enter an occupied enemy space, the characters that entered cannot continue moving this turn. Your other characters can still use any remaining moves normally.

RESOLVING CONFLICTS

After you've spent all your movement, resolve any space occupied by both players' characters or markers. Because you needed greater strength to enter, you've won the conflict:

- Remove any enemy control or corruption marker from the space.
- Rout all enemy characters.
- For each space where you routed enemy characters, advance your Banner one space.

TRAVELING

Some card effects use the keyword **Travel**. A character who Travels moves instantly to any space on the map — no movement icons required, no passing through intermediate spaces. Characters cannot Travel out of your Rout area. You may leave a control marker when a character Travels, by paying 1 crown.

Example Movement



Roland uses three moves to move Nynaeve and Thom into Tarabon, and then Nynaeve onward to Almoth Plain and then Falme. He pays a crown for a control marker in Tanchico, where they started. This gives him 3 spaces in this region: enough to control it.



Roland spends a move to move Egwene into Murandy, where Mat already is. Then he spends a second move to move them both into Caemlyn together to attack Rahvin.



Graendal and Lanfear each have 1 strength, for a total of 2 strength. Isabel could move them together into Caemlyn because Egwene has only 1 strength. However, Perrin is in the Two Rivers and currently has 4 strength. It would cost Isabel 3 crowns to move into that space.



Isabel moves Sammael into the Plains of Maredo, where Egwene is. Sammael will rout Egwene, but he can't move any further.

Reinforce



Strengthen your leaders and bring your defeated characters back to the board.

- Increase one leader's strength by 2.
- **Recover** your characters through the following process: The characters in your Ready area **Travel** to any friendly space on the board. Then advance the characters in your Rout area to Ready.
- If you have 3 or more 🌿 icons, make up to two moves into friendly or neutral spaces.
- You may perform these in any order.

Leader Strength

Your leaders are your most powerful characters. The Light's leaders each begin the game at strength 2; the Shadow's begin at strength 3. A leader's strength can grow as high as 10.

At the end of the game, you'll score 2 VP for each leader matchup you win — your strongest against theirs, your second against theirs, your weakest against theirs.

Effects that change leader strength use these icons:



Basic recruit: Increase one of your leaders' strength by 1 (maximum 10).



Elite recruit: Increase one of your leaders' strength by 2 (maximum 10).



Kill: Decrease one of your opponent's leaders' strength by 1 (minimum 0).



When the Shadow earns this reward from their Wheel Track, the strength increase must be given to Sammael. If Sammael is already at the maximum of 10 strength, the increase is lost.

When you gain multiple recruit icons at once, you may distribute the increases among your leaders however you like — unless an icon is paired with a specific leader's flag, in which case that leader must receive it. If that leader is already at strength 10, the increase is lost.



A leader reduced to 0 strength is immediately sent to your Rout area. A leader in Ready with 0 strength cannot return to the board until they have gained at least 1 strength.

Routing and Recovery

When characters are routed, place them in your Rout area (bottom-left of the board for the Light; top for the Shadow). You may not leave a control marker when a character is routed out of a space.

Routed and Ready characters must obey these rules:

- Characters in Rout cannot move or Travel, and cannot return to the map by any means.
- Characters in Ready can be affected by Travel card effects and certain abilities, but are not yet on the map.

Routed and Ready characters return to the board by **recovering**. When you **recover** during the game, follow the same process as you do in the Reinforce action:

- Any group of your Ready characters Travels to a friendly space. Characters you don't deploy now stay in Ready until the next recovery.
- Then all your Routed characters advance to Ready.

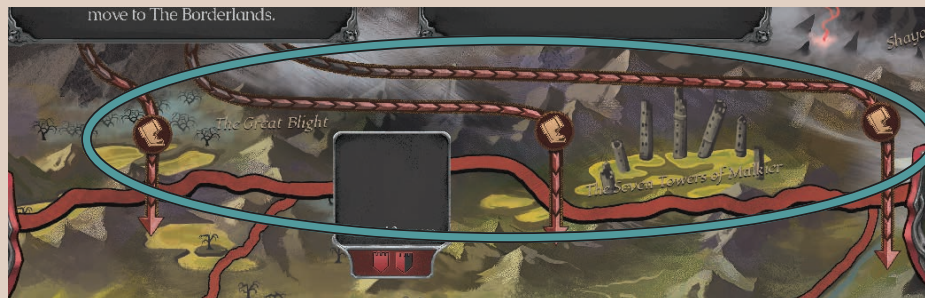
Both players also **recover** automatically at the end of each Chapter — so no character stays out of the fight forever.



When Roland recovers, Perrin can Travel from Ready to Shadow Coast or Amadicia, since Roland controls those spaces - but not to Ebou Dar.

Then Rand and Nynaeve advance from Rout to Ready.

Shadow Only: Shadow may also use normal movement to bring Ready characters directly into the Borderlands spaces — Saldaea, Kandor & Arafel, or Shienar. Normal movement rules still apply.



STRATEGY

Reinforce is most valuable when you have characters to recover and a leader that needs building. The bonus moves (with leaf icons) let you reposition while recovering — compressing two actions into one.

Consolidate



Fill your treasury and, if you're Shadow, extend your corruption.

- Gain 3 crowns from the supply.
- **Light:** Increase one leader's strength by 1.
- **Shadow:** Place a corruption marker in a friendly city space (see Corruption, below).
- If you have 3 or more  icons, advance your Banner two spaces.
- You may perform these in any order.

Example Turn

Isabel plays *Rats and Ravens* from her hand and moves her pawn to the Consolidate action.



Isabel uses the effect of *Rats and Ravens* to place a control marker in Maradon, which no one currently controls. She now gains control of it.

Then Isabel uses the Consolidate action. She takes 3 crowns from the supply, and she places a corruption marker in Maradon, now that she controls it. This replaces the normal Shadow control marker. Isabel advances her Corruption one space.



Isabel doesn't have three  icons to gain the bonus effect from this action, so she ends her turn.

Corruption

The Shadow's corruption spreads through the cities of the Westlands. To corrupt a city, choose one you control that isn't already corrupted and place a corruption marker there, replacing any normal control marker.

Corruption provides the Shadow with the following:

- Immediately advance your Corruption one space, gaining any reward on that space.
- At the end of each Chapter, advance your Corruption once for each corrupted city still on the map.
- A corruption marker holds the space for the Shadow just like a control marker and even provides 1 strength, so a 1-strength Light character can't take the city by themselves.

Corruption applies only to cities. When the Light takes control of a corrupted city, the corruption marker is removed just like a normal control marker.

STRATEGY

Consolidate keeps your options open. Crowns let you contest occupied actions and leave control markers when you move. For the Shadow, spreading corruption early pays dividends every chapter through automatic Corruption advancement.

Weave



Advance your Wheel and pour influence into a mission.

The Wheel turns and the One Power pours into the stories unfolding across the land. You may take the following in any order:

- Advance your Wheel tracker clockwise two spaces.
- Choose a mission with a skill icon matching the card you played this turn. (If neither mission matches, skip this step.) Count your icons for that skill and add that many of your control markers to that Mission.
- If you have 3 or more ♦ icons, draw a Power card.

STRATEGY

Weave is your primary tool for winning missions and building Wheel progress. Build your Pattern around skills that appear on missions you care about — the more matching icons you have, the more influence you can pour in.

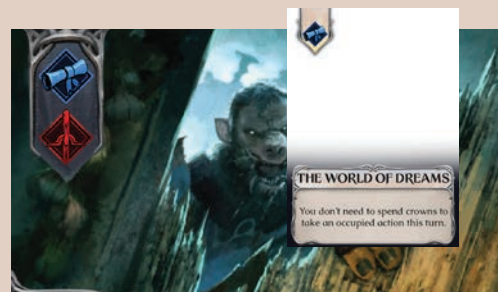
If neither mission matches your card's skill icon, you still advance your Wheel — the mission influence step simply doesn't happen.

Example Turn

Roland wants to take the Weave action to influence the mission *Trolloc Raids*, which has the ♦ and ♦ skill icons. He therefore plays *The World of Dreams* from his hand, which has a matching ♦ icon.



Roland's pawn is already on Weave, but *The World of Dreams* allows him to skip paying crowns for an occupied action. He pays nothing and leaves his pawn on that action.



Roland advances his Wheel tracker two spaces, gaining a crown.



Roland has four ♦ icons in his play area: 3 in his Pattern and 1 on *The World of Dreams*. He adds 4 Light control markers to *Trolloc Raids*. He now has 7 control markers and is currently in the lead.

Then Roland ends his turn.



Chapter Resolution

When both players have played their last card, the Chapter ends. Resolve the following steps in order. Each step begins with the player who took the first turn in this Chapter.

RECOVERY

Each player **recovers**. (Any group of Ready characters may Travel to a friendly space, then all Routed characters advance to Ready.)

MISSIONS

Resolve the Snake mission first, then the Fox mission.

For each mission, count both players' total influence: control markers count as 1, mission bonus tokens count as 2. The player with more influence wins and takes the reward shown for their side. If only a common reward is shown, the winner takes that. On a tie, neither player wins the mission.

Discard the mission card, remove its mission markers from the board, and return all tokens to the supply. Mission bonus tokens cannot be added, flipped, or removed during this step — even if a mission space changes hands.



Light wins this mission. Roland advances his Banner three spaces and reduces one of Isabel's leader's strength by 2.

MAP SCORING

Each player counts the banner icons on their controlled regions and advances their Banner that many spaces. Two half-banners combine into one full banner. Unmatched half-banners are lost.

Shadow also advances their Corruption once for each corrupted city still on the map.

Advance the Chapter tracker one space. Begin the next Chapter or, after Chapter 3, proceed to Final Scoring.



Region control and corruption on this map are enlarged for clarity.

Roland controls three regions worth a total of five banners. He advances the Light Banner tracker five spaces.

Isabel controls two regions worth a total of three-and-a-half banners. She advances the Shadow Banner tracker three spaces.

*There are three corrupted cities.
Isabel advances the Corruption tracker
three spaces.*

A Few More Rules

CITIES

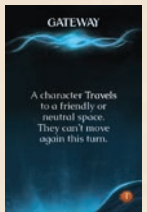
City spaces are identified by a distinctive illustrated frame. They are the Shadow's corruption targets — corruption usually cannot spread to non-city spaces. Some other game effects also specifically target cities.



POWER CARDS

Power cards are a bonus hand that sits outside your regular deck. You earn them from the Weave action, your Wheel Track, and other effects. Playing a Power card doesn't count as taking a turn or affect when a Chapter ends. Each card says when it can be played and what it does. After playing one, resolve its effects and discard it.

Power cards can also be discarded to boost your characters' strength by 1 to help you enter an enemy space, the same way crowns can.



TRACK REWARDS

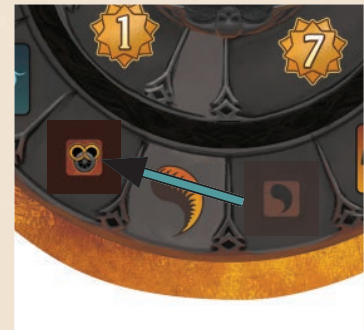
Whenever a tracker reaches a space with a reward icon, gain that reward. If a tracker reaches a space showing a character, place that character in any space you control — they are now yours to use like any other character.

WHEN YOUR TRACK RUNS OUT

If a Banner or Corruption tracker would advance past the end of its track, take 1 crown for each additional space it would have moved. The marker stays at the end of the track.



The Wheel works differently. If your Wheel tracker completes a full circuit clockwise and reaches the sigil on the Inner Wheel, flip it to its "Wheel icon" side and keep advancing normally. At Final Scoring, your Wheel position scores as usual, plus a bonus 7 VP for the completed circuit.



The back of a Wheel tracker indicates a complete circuit of the track.

TRASHING

When you trash a card, create a trash pile. Do not put it in a discard pile. That card is now out of the game completely.

Final Scoring

After three Chapters, the side better prepared for the Last Battle wins. Flip the action board to its scoring side, place each player's action pawn on the 0 space of their score track, and score these categories in order:

YOUR TRACKS

Each player scores VP equal to the highest value their Banner tracker reached or passed during the game. Shadow also scores VP equal to the highest value their Corruption tracker reached or passed.

Then compare the total region banners each player controls on the map. The player with more banners scores 3 additional VP. (Half-banners do count for this comparison.)



Isabel scores 4 VP from the Banner tracker and 3 VP from the Corruption tracker, for a total of 7.

YOUR WHEEL

Score the VP shown on the Inner Wheel at your Wheel tracker's current position.



If your marker is on the “Wheel icon” side (you completed a full circuit), add 7 VP.

YOUR PATTERN

For each of the five skills, whoever has more icons in their Pattern scores 2 VP. Tied skills score nothing for either player.

YOUR LEADERS

Match your leaders against your opponent's from highest strength to lowest, one comparison at a time. Score 2 VP for each comparison where your leader is stronger. Ties score nothing.

When two of your leaders have the same strength, either may be used for each comparison.



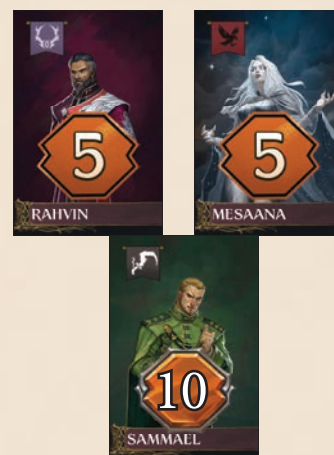
Roland's leaders have strengths of 7, 6, and 5. Isabel's have strengths of 10, 5, and 5.

Isabel wins the first comparison (10 beats 7, Isabel scores 2 VP).

Roland wins the second (6 beats 5, Roland scores 2 VP).

The third is tied — neither scores.

Final leader score: 2 VP each.



REMAINING RESOURCES

Each player counts their remaining Power cards and crowns combined. The player with more total resources scores 1 VP. A tie scores nothing.

DECLARING A WINNER

The player with the higher VP total wins. On a tied score, the Shadow wins — they don't need to win the Last Battle outright; they just need the Light not to win.

Icon Guide – Hero Mode



Move a group of characters to an adjacent space.



Place your control marker in an indicated space or on a mission. Cannot target a space with enemy characters. Can replace a lone enemy control marker.



Take the top ally card from the deck and add it to your Pattern. Do not gain any favors.



Gain an ally card's favor through the Ally action.



Increase the strength of one of your leaders by 1.



Increase the strength of one of your leaders by 2.



Reduce the strength of one of your opponent's leaders by 1.



Gain a crown from the supply.



Advance your Banner one space.



Advance your Banner two spaces.



Advance the Shadow Corruption tracker one space.



Advance your Wheel tracker one space.



Draw a Power card.



Victory points — the player with the most at game end wins.



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War of the Dragon: The Wheel of Time® Draft Rulebook — Work in Progress — May 28, 2026



EPIC MODE

This game is still in development.

This rulebook (and all images shown) are a work in progress.

The Wheel of Time turns, and Ages come and pass, leaving memories that become legend.

Epic Mode is the full War of the Dragon experience. Armies march across the Westlands. The Forsaken break free of their prison. Rand al'Thor grows from uncertain young man into the Dragon Reborn. Everything builds toward Tarmon Gai'don — the Last Battle — where both sides bring everything they've earned to fight for the fate of the world.



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What's Different in Epic Mode

These rules assume you've played Hero Mode. Not everything from that rulebook is repeated here — this document covers what's new or changed.

Epic Mode adds three major elements to the game:

A BIGGER STRUCTURE

Epic Mode includes a Prologue battle before the Chapters begin, four Chapters instead of three (with new systems for both players), and a final Last Battle that determines the ultimate winner. The game doesn't end with Final Scoring — it ends on the battlefield.

ARMIES AND BATTLES

Each side commands armies — large forces represented by figures on the map, each composed of up to 10 troop cards. When armies meet, a battle occurs.

In a battle, both players secretly assign their forces to three battle positions. Your troops, accompanying characters, and even the terrain on which the battle is fought all shape what you win or lose. Battles replace the simple conflict resolution from Hero Mode — and they're used to open the game (the Prologue) and close it (The Last Battle).

Each character also has a character card with their battle statistics. When a character is present in a battle, add their card to the forces at that position.



Armies are large figures with a corresponding icon.



Each army is made up of troop cards, kept on your player board.

SIDE-SPECIFIC SYSTEMS

Each side gains a powerful new tool that drives their unique strategy.

The Light develops their five starting characters — Rand, Perrin, Mat, Egwene, and Nynaeve — as the game progresses. Each level unlocks new abilities and adds to their Pattern.

The Shadow works to free the Forsaken from The Dark One's Prison — a deck of 11 powerful cards. Freeing them grants unique advantages and drives the Shadow's strategy throughout the game.

Both sides also gain event cards representing key story moments. Completing events advances your Event Track, earning VP and ultimately a bonus tile for The Last Battle.

The Last Battle

Everything in Epic Mode builds toward The Last Battle. There are still many VP available during regular play, but often the decisive points are earned on the battlefield at the end. Balance your efforts between preparing your forces, scoring points during Chapters, and earning advantages for the final confrontation.



Setup

Follow the Hero Mode setup instructions with the following changes and additions.

In our examples throughout this rulebook, Roland plays the Light and Isabel plays the Shadow.

1. SET OUT THE SHARED BOARDS

Use the main board, the Epic Mode Chapter board, and the Epic Mode action board (not the Hero Mode action board).

2. PREPARE THE DECKS

Do not remove heron-marked cards — all cards are used in Epic Mode.



Also shuffle the neutral character cards and each event deck separately and place them on the Chapter board.

3. EACH PLAYER PREPARES THEIR AREA

Starting decks are different in Epic Mode — *Ta'veren* (Light) and *The Taint on Saidin* (Shadow) are included, not set aside. Also take a battle board (on the side with three sections) and an Inner Wheel disc (emblem aligned with the Wheel Track starting space).



Light (10 cards):

- A Game of Dice
- Call to Arms
- Lan Mandragoran
- Leavetaking
- Moiraine Damodred
- Preparations
- Ta'veren
- The Flame and the Void
- The One Power
- The World of Dreams

Shadow starting deck (13 cards):

- Meetings in Secret
- Rats and Ravens
- Shadowsworn Oaths
- The Black Ajah
- The Pit of Doom
- The Shadow's Touch
- The Taint on Saidin
- The Ways
- The Weakening Seals (5 cards)

Each player also places their starting character cards in a lineup in front of their player board:

- **Light:** Rand al'Thor, Perrin Aybara, Mat Cauthon, Egwene al'Vere, Nynaeve al'Meara — all at level 1
- **Shadow:** Rahvin, Sammael, Padan Fain, and the Corrupted Space card (a battle card used when fighting in corrupted spaces — see Battle Rules)

Place armies on your player board (troop cards face-down in piles):

Light:

- **Wolf Army:** 1 Townsfolk, 2 Dragonsworn, 1 Infantry, 1 Archers
- **Aiel Army:** 2 Aiel, 1 Dragonsworn, 2 Townsfolk
- **Hand Army:** 1 Infantry, 1 Crossbow, 3 Dragonsworn
- **Tower Army:** 2 Channeler, 1 Infantry, 2 Townsfolk

Shadow:

- **Sword Army:** 1 Myrddraal, 2 Trollocs, 2 Darkfriends
- **Horns Army:** 1 Draghkar, 3 Trollocs, 1 Gray Man
- **Raven Army:** 1 Myrddraal, 4 Trollocs

Set the dial below each army stack to indicate the number of troops in it.

6. PLACE SET TRACKERS

Place the two ally reward tokens on the marked spaces of Shadow's Corruption Track (not Light's Banner Track as in Hero Mode).



8. BUILD THE MISSION DECK

The Epic Mode Mission Deck is built differently — use this procedure instead:

- Shuffle the ten 3-pip missions and deal two face-down.
- Shuffle the thirty 2-pip missions and deal four face-down on top.
- Shuffle the five 1-pip missions and deal two face-down on top.
- You now have an 8-card Mission Deck. Return all remaining missions to the box without revealing them.



Main board



Chapter board



Action board

9. SET UP THE MAP

Use the following starting positions instead of the Hero Mode positions:

Shadow:

- Rahvin (blue leader base) in Caemlyn, with a corruption marker
- Sammael (blue leader base) in Illian, with a corruption marker
- Padan Fain (black base) in Amadicia
- Sword Army in The Two Rivers
- Horns Army in Kandor & Arafel
- Raven Army in Shadow's Ready area

Light:

- Rand, Mat, and Egwene (yellow leader bases) in Tear
- Perrin (yellow leader base) and Wolf Army in The Two Rivers
- Nynaeve (yellow leader base) in Tanchico
- Aiel Army in Rhuidean
- Hand Army in Light's Ready area

Additional Epic Mode Setup Steps

After completing the modified Hero Mode steps, also do the following:

A. PREPARE ADDITIONAL COMPONENTS

Also set aside the following near the play area:

- 8 special troop cards: 2 Darkhounds, 2 Ogier, 2 Dragons, 1 Trolloc Horde, 1 Demandred
- 7 special character cards: Be'lal, Graendal, Lan Mandragoran, Lanfear, Mazrim Taim, Mesaana, Semirhage
- White Tower Army and Thakan'dar Army figures
- Secrecy screen, Moghedien tile, additional character figures
- 6 Last Battle capstone tiles, 3 Last Battle terrain tiles

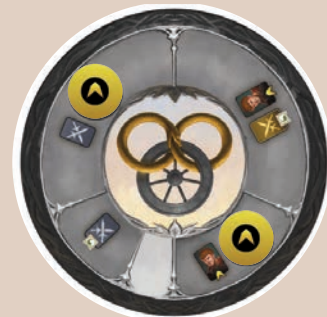
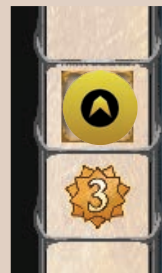


B. LEADER TOKENS



Shuffle the four leader tokens face-down without looking at them. Place:

- 1 on a marked space of Light's Banner Track (see at right)
- 2 on the Light Inner Wheel, covering the circled icons
- Return the fourth to the box without revealing it.



C. CREATE THE LEADER RESERVE

Set aside the 11 remaining character cards for the Light's five leaders: 3 cards for Rand al'Thor (levels 2, 3, and 4) and 2 cards each for Perrin, Mat, Egwene, and Nynaeve (levels 2 and 3). These are used when characters gain levels during play.

D. BUILD THE RESERVE DECKS

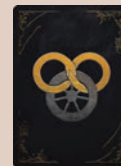
Shuffle separately and place on the Chapter board:

- Light Reserves: remaining Dragonsworn, Infantry, and Archers cards
- Shadow Reserves: remaining Trollocs, Myrddraal, Draghkar, and Gray Man cards
- Elite Reserves: remaining Aiel, Channeler, Crossbow, and Cavalry cards



E. SHUFFLE THE PRISON DECK

Shuffle the 11 Prison cards and place them face-down at The Dark One's Prison (upper right corner of the main board).



F. PLACE TERRAIN TILES

Place the six standard terrain tiles nearby, face-up for reference.

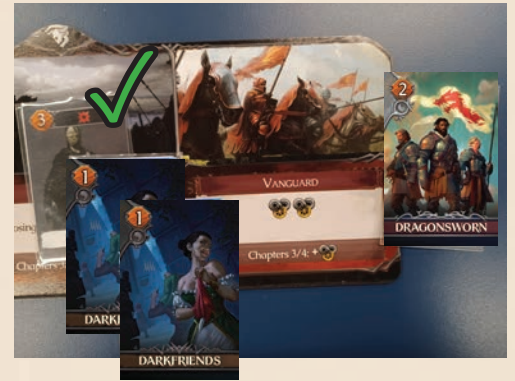


G. BEGIN WITH THE PROLOGUE

The game begins immediately with the Prologue battle. See Battle Rules on the next page.

Battle Rules

A battle occurs when both players have an army in the same space — including at the very start of the game, when both sides begin with armies in The Two Rivers.



Assign your forces based on your goals and the terrain on the field.

If you have more  than your opponent's  at a battle position, they must choose one of their troops to be killed.

The player with more strength () remaining wins the position and gains its reward.

In a battle, the player whose army moved into the space is the attacker; the player whose army was already there is the defender. In the Prologue, Shadow is the attacker and Light is the defender.

Each battle follows four steps:

- Engage
- Assign Forces
- Resolve Positions
- Rewards and Penalties

STEP 1: ENGAGE

Both players align their battle boards across from each other, with some space between them. The three battle positions — Vanguard, Center, and Flank — should face their matching positions on the opposing board.

Shuffle the terrain tiles face-down and assign one to each battle position, revealing them one at a time.

In the Prologue, shuffle and assign only the Flat, Fortified, and Tactical tiles.



The Engage step of a Prologue battle

TERRAIN

During battle, **terrain tiles** can change the rules or grant a bonus at each battle position. Evaluate where your advantages lie and which rewards or penalties are most important when determining where to fight!

See all of the terrain tiles on page 11.

Each player gathers their forces for the battle:

- The troop card stack for the army involved. (In the Prologue: Wolf Army for Light, Sword Army for Shadow.)
- Any character cards for characters present in the contested space. (In the Prologue: Light adds Perrin's card; Shadow adds none.)
- **Shadow Only:** if the battle is in a space with a corruption marker, also include the Corrupted Space card.



Light's Prologue forces.

Reveal your forces to your opponent for examination before proceeding.

HIT-AND-RUN (CHAPTERS 1 THROUGH 4 ONLY)

In any battle during Chapters 1 through 4 — not the Prologue or The Last Battle — once forces are revealed, the attacker may choose to make a Hit-and-Run attack instead of fighting a full battle.

In a Hit-and-Run: two random troops from the defending army are killed, then the attacking army is routed. Attacking characters are also routed unless another attacking army is present. The battle ends immediately.

STRATEGY

Hit-and-Run is most effective when your opponent's army is much stronger than yours, or when you want to weaken a defender before attacking with a second army.

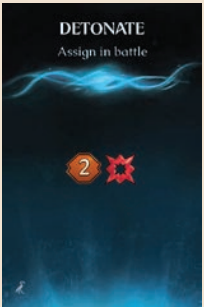
STEP 2: ASSIGN FORCES

Place the secrecy screen between the two battle boards across the terrain tiles. Both players can still see their own side of each terrain tile.

Each player secretly distributes their forces among the three battle positions. You may leave a position empty — or even two, if you want to concentrate everything on one reward.



Crowns and Power cards can also be assigned. Each crown provides 1 strength and 1 shield at its position. Power cards that specify battle effects provide what their text says; any other Power card provides 1 strength.



Power cards can be assigned in battle.

Some provide an especially potent boost!

STRATEGY: CASUALTIES

Before assigning, note how many attack icons (★) your opponent has in the battle. At any position where you don't have enough shields (🛡️) to match them, you'll take a casualty — plan which troop you could afford to lose.



Place any crowns or Power cards you wish to assign at the chosen position, along with your cards.

STEP 3: RESOLVE POSITIONS

Remove the secrecy screen and resolve each position in order: Vanguard, then Center, then Flank.

At each position, compare attack icons and shield icons for both players, including any terrain bonuses.

Any player with fewer shield icons than their opponent's attack icons takes a **casualty**: choose and kill one of your troops at that position, placing it face-up in the Grave (bottom-right of the main board). A player can take only one casualty per position, regardless of the deficit.

- If you have one or more character cards, but no troop cards at that position, return one character card to your lineup and rout that character from the battle space instead.
- If you have neither troops nor characters at the position, the casualty has no effect.

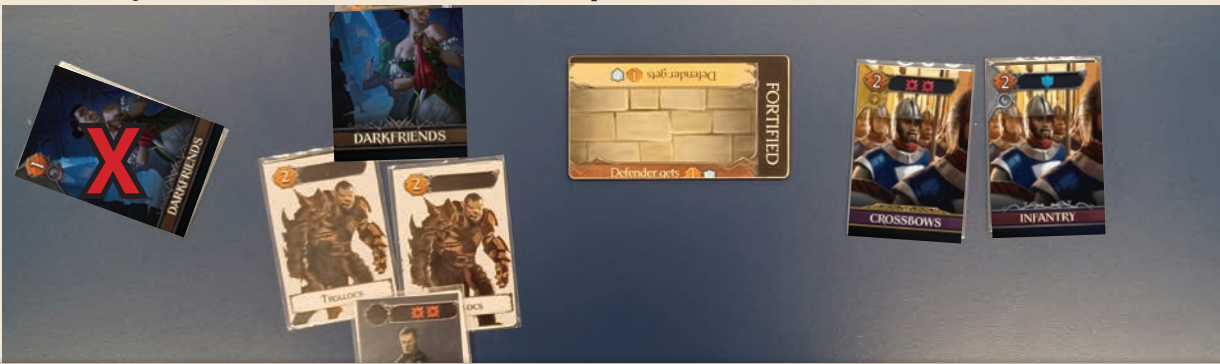


In this example, Isabel has one  icon on her Myrddraal troop at this battle position. Roland has zero  on his cards, and the Flat terrain tile offers no help.

Roland must choose one of his troops to be killed, so he chooses a Townsfolk.

Then add up the remaining strength values at the position for each player — including terrain, crowns, and other bonuses. The player with higher total strength wins the position.

- • Move the terrain tile to the winner's battle board to mark the win. Rewards are taken after all positions are resolved.
- • On a tied strength value, the attacker wins the position.



In this example, Isabel has two  icons at the Vanguard on her Gray Man troop. Roland has two  icons: one on his Infantry troop and one on the Fortified terrain tile, which benefits Roland because he is the defender in this battle. Roland does not take a casualty.

However, Roland has two  icons of his own on his Crossbow troop, and Isabel has no  icons. Therefore, she must take one casualty: in this case, a Darkfriends troop.

Both players end with a final strength of 5. (Roland's strength includes +1 from Fortified terrain.) Since Isabel is the attacker, she wins the position. Then the battle moves on to the Center.

Terrain Tiles

Each terrain tile modifies the rules or provides a bonus at its position:



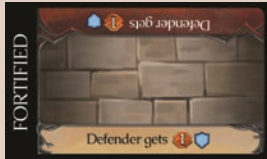
FLAT TERRAIN

The player who wins this position gains 1 crown.



FATEFUL TERRAIN

The player who wins this position places two control markers on a mission of their choice.



FORTIFIED TERRAIN

The defender gets +1 strength and +1 shield.



EXPOSED TERRAIN

The attacker gets +1 strength and +1 attack icon.



TACTICAL TERRAIN

Players may not assign crowns or Power cards to the position.



UNEVEN TERRAIN

The player who controls the region containing the battle space gets +2 strength.

STEP 4. REWARDS AND PENALTIES

Once all three positions are resolved, assess the results:

VANGUARD WINNER

- Advance your Wheel two spaces.
- In Chapters 3 and 4, advance three spaces instead.

CENTER WINNER

- Hold the space on the map. The loser's figures are routed, and any control or corruption marker they had there is also removed.
- In Chapters 3 and 4, the loser also takes one additional casualty from their surviving army.

FLANK LOSER

- Take two casualties from your surviving army.
- In Chapters 3 and 4, take three casualties instead.

If a position has the Flat or Fateful terrain tile, the winner also gains the bonus shown on that tile.

Finally, collect all surviving troop cards and return them face-down to their army stack on your player board. Return character cards to your lineup. Return any crowns spent to the supply. Discard any Power cards used.

KILLS AND CASUALTIES

When a troop is killed, remove it from its army and place it face-up in the Grave (bottom-right of the main board). The contents of the Grave are open information — either player may inspect it at any time.

When an effect inflicts a casualty on an army, the affected player chooses which troop from that army to kill.

New Rules for Epic Mode

MANAGING ARMIES

In Hero Mode, the recruit and kill icons affected leader strength. In Epic Mode, those same icons recruit and kill troop cards in armies.

When you recruit troop cards, draw them from one of three reserve decks (all found on the Chapter board): the Light Reserves, the Shadow Reserves, or the Elite Reserves. Look at the cards, then distribute them face-down among your army stacks however you choose.

Recruit effects in Epic Mode:



Basic recruit: Draw one card from your side's reserve deck (Light Reserves or Shadow Reserves) and add it to any of your armies.



Elite recruit: Draw one card from the Elite Reserves and add it to any of your armies. Elite troops are stronger than standard recruits.



Targeted recruit: When a recruit icon is paired with a specific army's icon, the new troop must go into that army. If that army is already at capacity, you may either take a casualty from it to make space, or forgo the recruit.



Kill: Choose one of your opponent's armies and kill one random troop from it.

Each army can hold a maximum of 10 troop cards, except Light's White Tower Army, which is unlimited.

An army that reaches 0 troop cards is immediately routed. A routed army with 0 troops cannot leave the Ready area until it has gained at least 1 troop card.

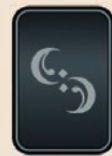
RECRUITING CHARACTERS

When you gain a new neutral character as a reward:

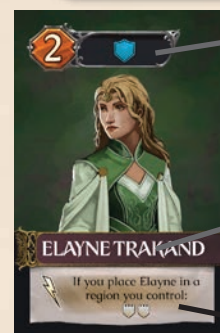
- Reveal the top two cards of the neutral character deck and choose one. Return the other to the box.
- Perform the special ability on the bottom of the chosen card. (If the ability depends on a future step — like the character's placement on the map — perform it when that step applies.)
- Take that character's figure, attach a base in your side's color, and place it in a friendly space.
- Add the chosen card to your character lineup.

When an effect tells you to recruit a specific named character (as several Prison cards do):

- Take that character's figure, attach a base in your side's color, and place it in a friendly space.
- Take their card from the special character card reserve and add it to your lineup.



The neutral character icon can be found on the Light Banner track, the Shadow Corruption track, and some events and missions.



Battle statistics

Character name

Immediate effect

EVENT CARDS

Each player has their own deck of event cards representing story moments and schemes from their side's experience in The Wheel of Time. Events either provide an immediate benefit, or they set conditions you must meet to earn a larger reward.



*Completed events go to the track on the event board.
The player who completes 7 events first earns a capstone tile in the Last Battle.*

When you receive an event card reward, draw the top card of your event deck and reveal it.

If the card begins with “Immediately,” resolve it right away: perform its effects, flip it face-down, and add it to the Event Track in the empty space nearest to you.



Otherwise, place it in one of your three event slots on the Chapter board. The card shows one or more requirements and possibly a cost:

- Requirements can include having certain skill icons, taking a specific action, having characters in a particular map space, or others.
- A cost appears before the payment arrow icon (→). You must give up the resources shown to gain the rewards after the arrow.

On any turn when you meet all the requirements and pay any cost shown, resolve the event: gain its rewards, flip it face-down, and add it to the Event Track in the nearest empty space.

You may only hold three unresolved event cards at a time. If you draw a fourth without an Immediate effect, discard one. Discarded cards do not go to the Event Track.



When a cost includes one or more moves, you may give up any kind of movement icons to satisfy it.

COMPLETING THE EVENT TRACK

When you resolve your seventh event card, place it in the center space of the Event Track — you’ve claimed the Event capstone tile for The Last Battle.

Any event cards resolved after the seventh (by either player) are discarded rather than added to the track.

STRATEGY

Event cards reward planning ahead. Requirements often align with actions you’d take anyway — building toward an event and your normal strategy simultaneously is the mark of a strong turn. Completing seven events first earns a bonus tile for The Last Battle.

Movement in Epic Mode

Epic Mode uses two distinct movement types where Hero Mode used one:



Move: Move a group of characters (no army) to an adjacent space.



March: Move a group that may include one army to an adjacent space.

Both types can be combined on a single Mobilize action, and you may use them in any order.

You cannot move one of your armies into a space that already contains another of your armies — unless an enemy army is also in that space.

CONTROL MARKERS AND ARMIES

When an army moves or Travels out of a space, you may leave a control marker behind for free. As with characters, you may only leave a control marker in a space where an army began its move.

When a character moves or Travels out of a space, you must still pay 1 crown to leave a control marker.

RESOLVING CONTESTED SPACES

The rules for entering and resolving contested spaces are modified from Hero Mode due to the presence of armies.

- Armies can always enter spaces containing only enemy characters. Characters cannot enter a space containing an enemy army unless they are grouped with a friendly army, or a friendly army is already in that space.
- Armies must stop in contested spaces.
- Characters (without an army) can enter a space containing only enemy characters or corruption markers if their total strength exceeds the defenders'. Unlike Hero Mode, you may not spend crowns to boost strength for this comparison.
- When you resolve a contested space containing only enemy characters — whether you entered with an army or characters alone — **push** those characters out rather than routing them. Move them to any adjacent space you don't control. If no such space exists, rout them instead and advance your Banner one space.
- When opposing armies meet in the same space, use the Battle rules.

If you move multiple armies into a space containing opposing armies during a single action, you must resolve each encounter as a Hit-and-Run until only one attacking army remains in a contested space — at which point you may choose either a full battle or a Hit-and-Run.

Example Movement

Roland moves Egwene into the Unclaimed Lands, paying a crown to leave a control marker in Tar Valon.

He then uses a “march” to move Egwene and the Aiel Army into Shienar to attack the Horn Army. He does not pay a crown to leave a control marker in Unclaimed Lands, since the Aiel Army started its movement there.



Roland uses two “marches” to move the Wolf Army into Andor from The Two Rivers and to move the Hand Army into Andor from Altara. He leaves a control marker in both starting spaces for free.

When resolving this contested space, Roland first uses the Hand Army to perform a Hit-and-Run, killing two troops from the Sword Army and routing the Hand Army.

Then he chooses to have a full battle between the Wolf Army and the depleted Sword Army.



Nynaeve has 1 strength, as seen on her character card. Padan Fain has 0 strength, as seen on his character card.

Therefore, Nynaeve can move into Padan Fain’s space and subsequently push him out.



Rand, Egwene, and Mat each have 1 strength, for a total of 3. Sammael has 3 strength by himself.

Therefore, neither of these groups can move into the other’s space. However, if one of the Light characters moved or was routed by another effect, Sammael could move into the space occupied by the other two. (At least, until they gain levels and get stronger!)

Special Rules

GAINING LEVELS (LIGHT)

One of the Light's defining goals is to develop their five starting characters as the game progresses. Characters can gain levels through Wheel and Banner progress, and through certain event and mission cards.

When a character gains a level:



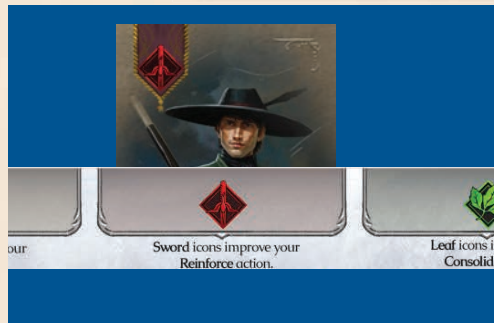
This icon from the Light Inner Wheel lets Rand gain a level.



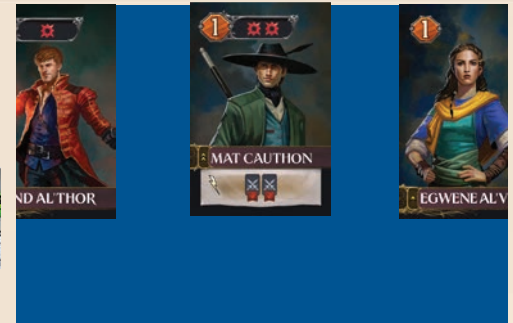
The leader tokens on Light's Inner Wheel and Banner track let the shown character gain a level.



Fetch the next card for that character from the Leader Reserve — the one with one more level pip beside the name than the current card.



Flip the character's current card face-down and add it to your Pattern, based on its skill icon.



Add the new card to your lineup and resolve its Immediate effect, if it has one.

Leveled-up character cards added to your Pattern count as ally cards for all Pattern purposes — they build your skill totals and contribute to bonus icon thresholds.

If a character is already at maximum level (no cards remaining in the Leader Reserve), or has been lost (such as due to the Balefire mission), the Light instead adds the top card of the ally deck to their Pattern when they would gain a level.

STRATEGY

Gaining levels builds your Pattern while making your leaders stronger on the map. Prioritize gaining levels for Rand through your Wheel — his higher-level cards provide significant advantages, and reaching his maximum level earns the Dragon capstone tile.

THE DARK ONE’S PRISON (SHADOW)

At the upper right corner of the main board, eleven cards represent the Forsaken — Shadow’s most powerful lieutenants, sealed in The Dark One’s Prison. Each card is unique and powerful. Freeing them is central to Shadow’s strategy.

When Shadow gains Prison icons (primarily from resolving their Inner Wheel at the end of a Chapter), they draw from the Prison deck and choose which Forsaken to keep:

- 
- Draw a number of cards equal to the total number of Prison icons gained.
 - Keep a number of cards equal to the number of Prison icons that aren’t marked by a slash. Discard the rest face-down.
 - Resolve the cards that you’ve chosen to keep one at a time, in the order you choose.

If the Prison deck runs out, shuffle the face-down discard pile and continue drawing from it. However, do not replenish the deck; only use these cards to draw enough to choose from.

If all 11 cards have been removed from The Dark One’s Prison by the end of the game — for any reason, even discards — Shadow claims the Prison capstone tile.

STRATEGY

Every card removed from the Prison, even discarded ones, counts toward the Prison capstone. Prioritize Prison icons on your Inner Wheel to maximize access to the Forsaken and build toward that endgame reward.

GAINING SPECIFIC COMPONENTS

In Epic Mode, there are a handful of missions and Prison cards that recruit a specific character or other component identified by name. The components for these effects have been set aside during step 3 of setting up the game (see page 4).

These are usually characters who have a character card and figure. If an effect calls for a different type of component, it will be identified in the text.

Chapter Rules

Epic Mode contains four Chapters instead of three. The flow of each Chapter is mostly the same as Hero Mode — this section covers what’s different.

HAND SIZES AND TURN ORDER

For each Chapter:

- Chapter 1: 5 cards, the Shadow goes first
- Chapter 2: 5 cards, the Light goes first
- Chapter 3: 6 cards, the Shadow goes first
- Chapter 4: 6 cards, the Light goes first

BETWEEN CHAPTERS

After Chapters 1 and 2, and before the next Chapter begins, each player draws an event card.

After Chapter 3, check all three tracks on the main board: if the Light’s Banner, the Shadow’s Banner, or the Shadow’s Corruption has reached the highest space on its track, the game ends early. Skip Chapter 4 and go directly to Endgame Preparations.

Otherwise, each player draws an Event card and Chapter 4 begins.

WHEEL TURNS

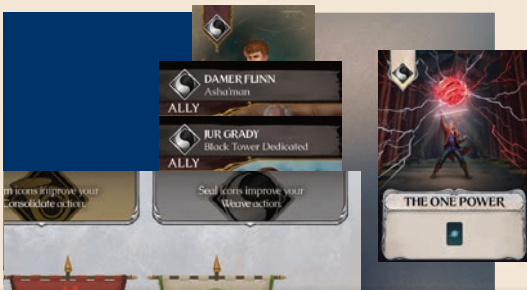
When it’s your turn and you have exactly one card left in your hand, you no longer take a normal turn. Instead, you take a Wheel Turn and advance your Wheel tracker.

On a Wheel Turn:

- Place your card in front of you, but don’t use its text or choose an action.
- Count how many icons of that card’s skill you have (including your Pattern, as usual). Advance your Wheel tracker that many spaces, gaining any rewards along the way, then discard the card.
- If you have more than 3 Power cards in hand at the end of your Wheel Turn, discard down to 3.

STRATEGY: WHEEL TURN

You get more from your Wheel Turn when your Pattern is rich in the skill that matches your final card. Plan ahead: save a card that matches your strongest skill, or build that skill’s icons throughout the Chapter.



Roland plays The One Power for his Wheel Turn. He has 3 more  icons in his Pattern, so he advances 4 spaces on his Wheel.

The text on The One Power is not used, so he does not draw a Power card.



Roland advances his Wheel tracker four spaces. He passes the “recruit” icon, so he recruits one troop from the Light Reserves.

INNER WHEEL REWARDS

During Chapter Resolution, immediately after missions are scored, both players gain rewards from their Inner Wheel.

Your Inner Wheel reward is determined by the section that aligns with your Wheel tracker's current position.

If your Wheel tracker completed a full circuit during the Chapter (it was flipped to the "Wheel icon" side), you also gain the reward from the highest Inner Wheel section — in addition to wherever the marker currently sits — then flip the marker back to its normal side. (If the circuit bonus and the current position both provide Prison icons, combine all icons gained together when determining how many cards to draw and keep from The Dark One's Prison.)

After collecting your reward, align the Inner Wheel emblem with your Wheel tracker's current position.

LIGHT'S INNER WHEEL

Light's Inner Wheel contains leader tokens and reward icons. When you collect a leader token, turn it face-up, the character shown on it gains a level, then discard it. If you earn that Inner Wheel section again later, you receive the reward on the Wheel section as normal (plus any other rewards in that section).

SHADOW'S INNER WHEEL

Shadow's Inner Wheel frees the Forsaken from The Dark One's Prison. Each section provides Prison icons — the more you advance your Wheel, the more Forsaken you can draw and keep. See The Dark One's Prison for how these icons work.



Roland's Wheel tracker is aligned with the second section of his Inner Wheel. He earns a leader token and a recruit as his rewards.



After collecting his Inner Wheel reward, Roland resets the position of his Inner Wheel.



This Chapter, Roland earns a recruit and Mat gains a level.

If Roland reaches this section again, he will get an elite recruit for the Tower army in addition to the normal recruit.

Endgame Preparations

Once all Chapters are complete — or the game ends early after Chapter 3 — both players assess their progress before The Last Battle.

SCORING

Flip the action board to its scoring side. Place each player's action pawn on the 0 space of their score track.

Both players now score all VP earned during the game:

- Banner and Corruption Tracks: score VP equal to the highest value each tracker reached or passed on its track.
- Event Track: each player scores VP equal to the furthest filled space on their side of the track.
- Character lineup: score any VP shown on character cards in your lineup.

This is not the final score — The Last Battle adds more. Consider carefully what you need going in.



Isabel scores 4 VP from the Shadow Banner Track, 3 VP from the Corruption Track, and 2 VP for characters, for a total of 9 VP.

CAPSTONE TILES

Several capstone tiles are awarded for excelling in specific areas:

- Pattern capstone: the player leading in more Pattern skills (more icons of that skill than their opponent).
- Map capstone: the player controlling regions worth more total banners. (Half-banners count.)
- Event capstone: the player who reached the center space of the Event Track.
- Dragon capstone (Light only): if Rand al'Thor reached his maximum level.
- Prison capstone (Shadow only): if The Dark One's Prison pile is empty. Resolve immediately — search the Grave and choose four troops, shuffle them, then add one at random to each of Shadow's three armies and one to the Shadow Reserves.

For any tied condition, neither player gets that tile.

ASSEMBLE FORCES

For each army still in a player's Rout or Ready area, that player takes two casualties of their choice from it.

BALANCE RESOURCES

The player with fewer remaining crowns discards all of theirs; the other player discards the same amount.

Power cards in hand are kept — they can be used in The Last Battle.

The Last Battle

Like the unfettered dawn shall he blind us, and burn us, yet shall the Dragon Reborn confront the Shadow at the Last Battle, and his blood shall give us the Light. Let tears flow, O ye people of the world. Weep for your salvation.

– *The Prophecies of the Dragon*

The Last Battle is a full-scale showdown using the same basic rules as earlier battles but at greater scale and with higher stakes. Both sides bring everything — armies, characters, capstone tiles, and any special components earned during the game.

STEP 1: ENGAGE

Both players flip their battle boards to The Last Battle side and gather all their forces:

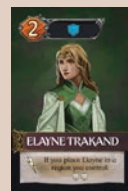
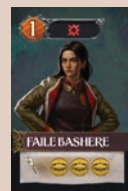
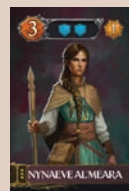
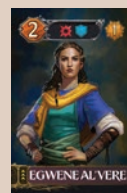
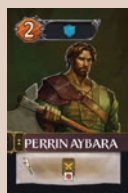
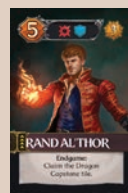
- Their three armies from the map
- Their fourth army: White Tower Army (Light) or Thakan'dar Army (Shadow)
- Their character lineup cards
- Their capstone tiles
- Any remaining crowns and Power cards
- Any special components earned during play (Moghedien tile, missions with Last Battle effects, etc.)

Shuffle the three **Last Battle terrain tiles** face-down and assign one to each of the first three battle positions, revealing them as assigned.

Assign any capstone tiles with a prescribed battle position now. Hold tiles without a prescribed position until Step 2.

KEY DIFFERENCES FROM EARLIER BATTLES

- Do not reveal your troop cards to your opponent.
- There are four battle positions, not three.
- Assign one full army to each battle position (rather than individual troops).
- Each unblocked  causes a casualty — not a maximum of one per position.
- There is no attacker or defender. Tied positions go to neither player.
- Take rewards immediately when you win a position.



The assembled forces of the Light

STEP 2: DEPLOY

Place the secrecy screen between the boards. Each player secretly deploys their forces among the four battle positions.

Assign exactly one army to each battle position. If one of your armies has zero troops, skip assigning it — one position will go without an army, though you may still assign characters and other resources there.

Everything other than armies — characters, Power cards, crowns, capstone tiles — can be assigned freely to any position, unless the component specifies otherwise.

THAKAN'DAR (SHADOW)

The Shadow receives a fourth army in The Last Battle: Thakan'dar. This army contains all troop cards remaining in the Shadow Reserves.

Example Last Battle Deployment



Roland has assigned one army to each of the four battle positions. He has assigned his capstone tiles according to their individual rules: the Dragon capstone tile is at the Field of Merrilor, and the Pattern capstone tile is at the Siege of Caemlyn. His characters and crowns are assigned freely.

STEP 3: RESOLVE

Remove the secrecy screen. Resolve each position in order, starting at the Blightborder and proceeding as shown on the battle boards.

At each position, compare attack icons and shield icons. For each attack icon your opponent has that you can't block with a shield, take one casualty.

- If you run out of troop cards, remove character cards from your lineup until you've met the deficit or have no forces remaining.

Then compare total strength. The player with higher strength wins the position.

- Award VP immediately to the winner.
- Assess any special text at the position immediately.
- Tied positions go to neither player.

Example Position Resolution



Roland has a total of five  icons, coming from his troop cards and the Pattern capstone tile.

Isabel has only two  icons, so she must take three casualties.

Isabel has four  icons on her troop cards, but Roland has five  icons thanks to the crowns he played here. Therefore, he takes no casualties. Due to the special text on the Scorched terrain tile, Roland scores 2 VP.

Roland's forces have a total of 20 strength. Isabel's forces have a total of 24 strength, even after taking casualties, so she wins the position. Isabel scores 4 VP.

DECLARING A WINNER

After the Shayol Ghul position is resolved, compare total VP scores. The player with the higher total wins — they have claimed dominion over the Pattern for the coming Age.

On a tied VP score, the winner is the player who most recently gained VP.

Icon Guide

STANDARD REWARDS



Move a group of characters (no army) to an adjacent space.



Move a group of characters and/or one army to an adjacent space.



Place your control marker in an indicated space or on a mission. Cannot target a space with enemy figures. Can replace a lone enemy control marker.



Take the top ally card from the deck and add it to your Pattern. Do not gain any favors.



Gain an ally card's favor through the Ally action.



Draw one troop card from your side's reserve deck and add it to any of your armies.



Draw one troop card from the Elite Reserves and add it to any of your armies.



Choose one of your opponent's armies and kill one random troop from it.



Gain a crown from the supply.



Advance your Banner one space.



Advance the Shadow Corruption tracker one space.



Advance your Wheel tracker one space.



Draw a Power card.



Draw an event card from your event deck.



Reveal two neutral character cards and choose one to recruit.



Victory points — the player with the most at game end wins.

LEADER AND WHEEL SPECIFIC REWARDS



Reveal this token. The character shown gains a level, then discard the token.



Draw one troop from your reserve deck and add it to the specified army.



Rand al'Thor gains a level.



Draw a card from the Dark One's Prison and resolve it.



Discard a card from the Dark One's Prison face-down without resolving it.

BATTLE ICONS



A strength value used in battle and to determine if characters can push each other.



An unblocked attack icon forces your opponent to take a casualty.



Each shield icon blocks one of your opponent's attack icons.

OTHER ICONS

CONSOLIDATE:

The action you must take on your turn to resolve an event card or play a Power card. You must also meet any other requirements shown.



Pay the resources before the arrow to gain the rewards after it.



4-PLAYER MODE

This game is still in development.

This rulebook (and all images shown) are a work in progress.

This variant of Hero Mode adds an additional player to both sides, becoming a four-player experience. The two players on each team act together in concert and either win or lose together.

Both players for each team should sit on the same side of the table, next to each other. Nominate one player from each team to manage the team's player board, including the Pattern, leader strength dials, and Wheel Track. The other player manages the team's progress tracks on the main board.

During the game, each player will have their own supply of crowns and their own hands of cards, including Power cards. Other team resources, like the Pattern, are shared. Team members may discuss strategy freely, but all discussions must be public, and teammates may not show each other cards from their hands.



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War of the Dragon: The Wheel of Time® Draft Rulebook — Work in Progress — May 28, 2026

Setup

Follow the Hero Mode setup instructions with the following changes and additions.

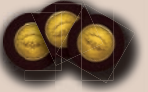
3. EACH PLAYER PREPARES THEIR AREA

Each team takes their action token, in addition to their normal action pawn.

The Light players start their leaders at 3 strength, rather than 2.

5. CROWNS

All four players take 3 crowns.



Playing the Game

When drawing hands at the start of a Chapter, all four players draw three cards from their team's deck, regardless of which Chapter it is. If a team's deck doesn't have enough cards for both players' hands, the players should alternate their draws, starting with the player who manages the player board, and replenishing the deck by reshuffling their discard pile when necessary.

During play, both players on a team take their turns back-to-back. When it is a team's turn to act, the two players decide between them who will take their turn first and who will take their turn second.

- When the first player on a team takes their turn, they place the team's action token on the action they choose. They must still pay the normal amount of crowns if that action is occupied.
- When the second player takes their turn, they use the team's action pawn as normal. However, they may not choose the action that their teammate did (the one with the team's action token on it).
- After both players have taken a turn, they remove their action token from the action board. Then play passes to the other team.

During your turn, you receive any crowns or Power cards, and you make any choices for other benefits, such as movement on the map or which leader's strength to increase.

On a team's **third** set of turns in a chapter (when the players each have a single card left), the first player uses the action pawn instead of the action token. The second player then takes a **Wheel Turn**:

- The player places their card in front of them, but doesn't use its text or choose an action.
- Count how many icons of that card's skill the team has (including the card played and the Pattern). The team advances their Wheel tracker that many spaces, gaining any rewards along the way, then discards the card.
- (These are the same rules for this mechanic as seen in Epic Mode.)

Chapter Resolution

If a team earns any rewards during Chapter Resolution, such as from a mission reward, they are assigned as the team chooses; if the teammates cannot agree, the player managing the team's player board chooses. Crown or Power card rewards can be given to either player, but once taken, they are that player's permanently.

Final Scoring

The players on each team merge their remaining crowns and Power cards before comparing those totals for scoring.